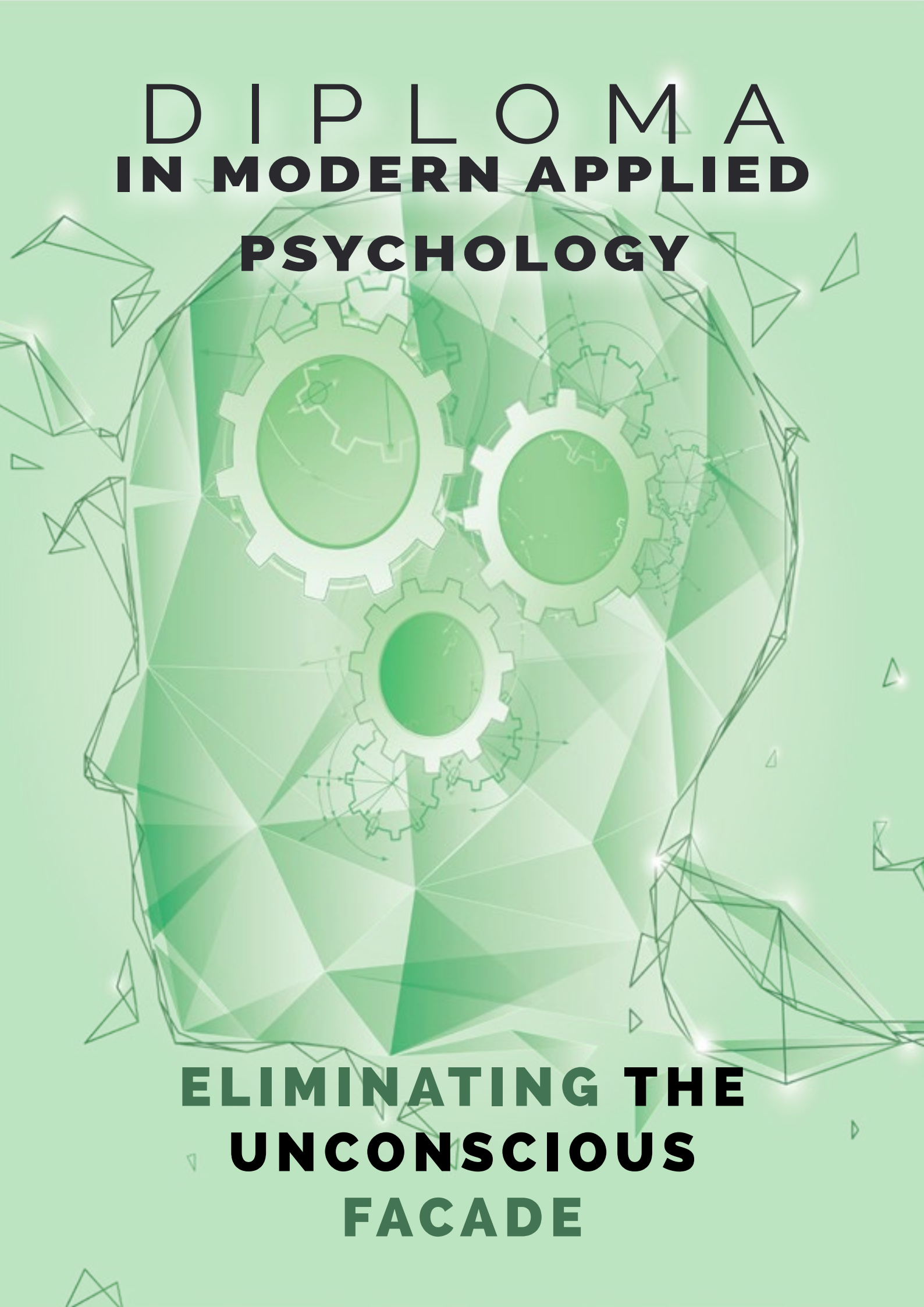


The background is a vibrant green with a complex, abstract geometric pattern. It features a large, central, multi-faceted shape resembling a crystal or a stylized head. Overlaid on this are several interlocking gears of different sizes, some in white and some in green. Thin, white lines and arrows crisscross the background, suggesting a network or a process. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological.

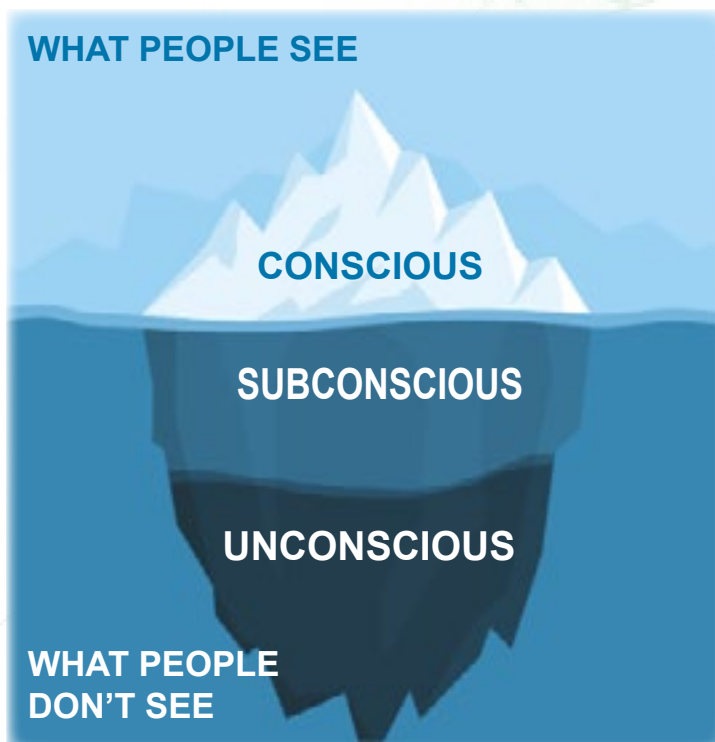
DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

ELIMINATING THE UNCONSCIOUS FACADE

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Pierre Janet argued that if a person showed signs of distress and upset for no apparent reason, their distress was being caused by an unconscious idea of belief. He then went on to argue that this could lead to either dissociation (i.e. detachment from physical and emotional experiences) or to the harbouring of the experience within the subconscious.

Janet's theory of dissociation and subconsciousness is intricately linked to Freud's Iceberg theory which argued that there were three levels of consciousness. We can use an iceberg as a helpful metaphor to understand how much of ourselves we choose to reveal to other people. As an iceberg floats in the water, the vast mass of it remains below the surface. Only a small percentage of the whole iceberg is visible above the surface, and the largest and most influential part remains unseen below the surface.



CONSCIOUS

The first level of consciousness is known as the conscious state, and this refers to the rational awareness that guides our everyday decisions. We make use of our conscious mind when we take in input from our senses, analyse the information, and then make decisions based on this information.

SUBCONSCIOUS

The next level of consciousness, the subconscious, is fairly dim in awareness: it's the stuff that dreams are made of. We can consider it as the storehouse of all remembered experiences, impressions that are left on the mind by such experiences, and tendencies that are awakened or reinforced by these impressions.

Every experience you've ever had, every thought, every impression lives in the subconscious mind and influences our patterns of thought and behaviour far more than we realise.

The subconscious holds information that is just below the surface of awareness. An individual can retrieve such information with relative ease, and we usually refer to these as memories.

The conscious mind consists of what we are aware of at any given point in time. It includes the things that we are thinking about right now, whether it's in the front of our minds or the back. If we're aware of it, then it is in the conscious mind.

For example, at this moment you may be consciously aware of the information you're reading, the sound of the music you're listening to, or a conversation you're having. All of the thoughts that pass through your mind, the sensations and perceptions from the outside world, and the memories that you bring into your awareness are all part of that conscious experience.



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For example, if someone asked you right now what your middle name was, you would be able to recall it. Or if someone asked you what your father's birthday was or when it last rained.

UNCONSCIOUS

The final level of unconsciousness is known as the unconscious. This is made up of thoughts, memories, and primitive/instinctual desires that are buried deep within ourselves, far below our conscious awareness. Even though we're not aware of their existence, they have a significant influence on our behaviour.

Although our behaviours tend to indicate the unconscious forces driving them, we can't readily access the information which is stored in the unconscious mind. Throughout our childhood, we gathered many different memories and experiences that formed the beliefs, fears and insecurities that we carry today. However, we cannot recall most of these memories. They are unconscious forces that drive our behaviours.

For example, things in your unconscious that might be forgotten include negative experiences from your past, a strong dislike for a parent, or a traumatic event that you pushed out of your subconscious.

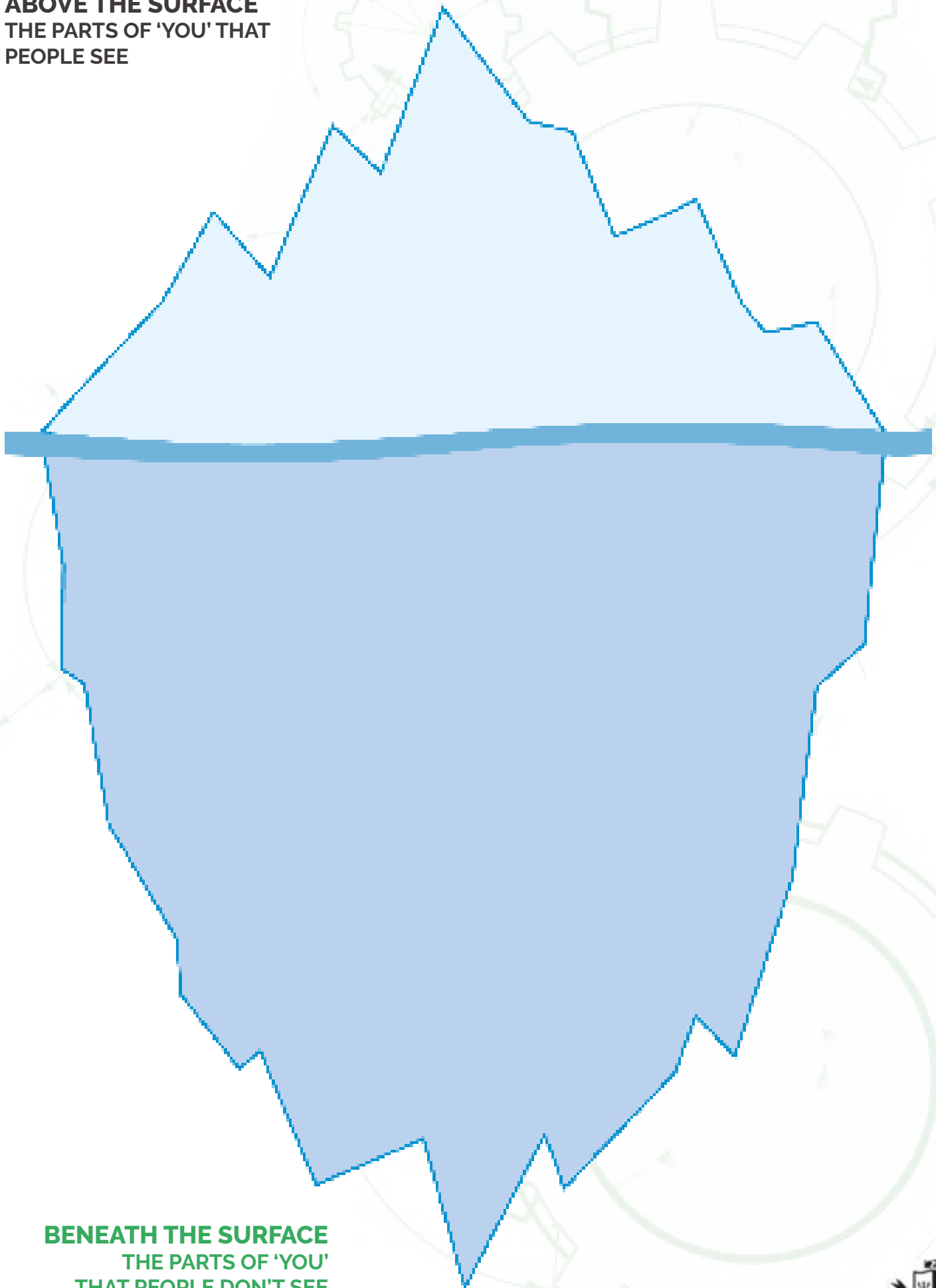
In exactly the same way, each of us will often have a part of ourselves that we reveal to others, with the larger part of ourselves being deeply submerged that no-one ever gets to see.

Complete the exercise on the pages that follow by writing down the parts of you that can be seen and experienced by others, the parts that can't, and the parts that you'd like others to see if you were to show them...



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ABOVE THE SURFACE
THE PARTS OF 'YOU' THAT
PEOPLE SEE

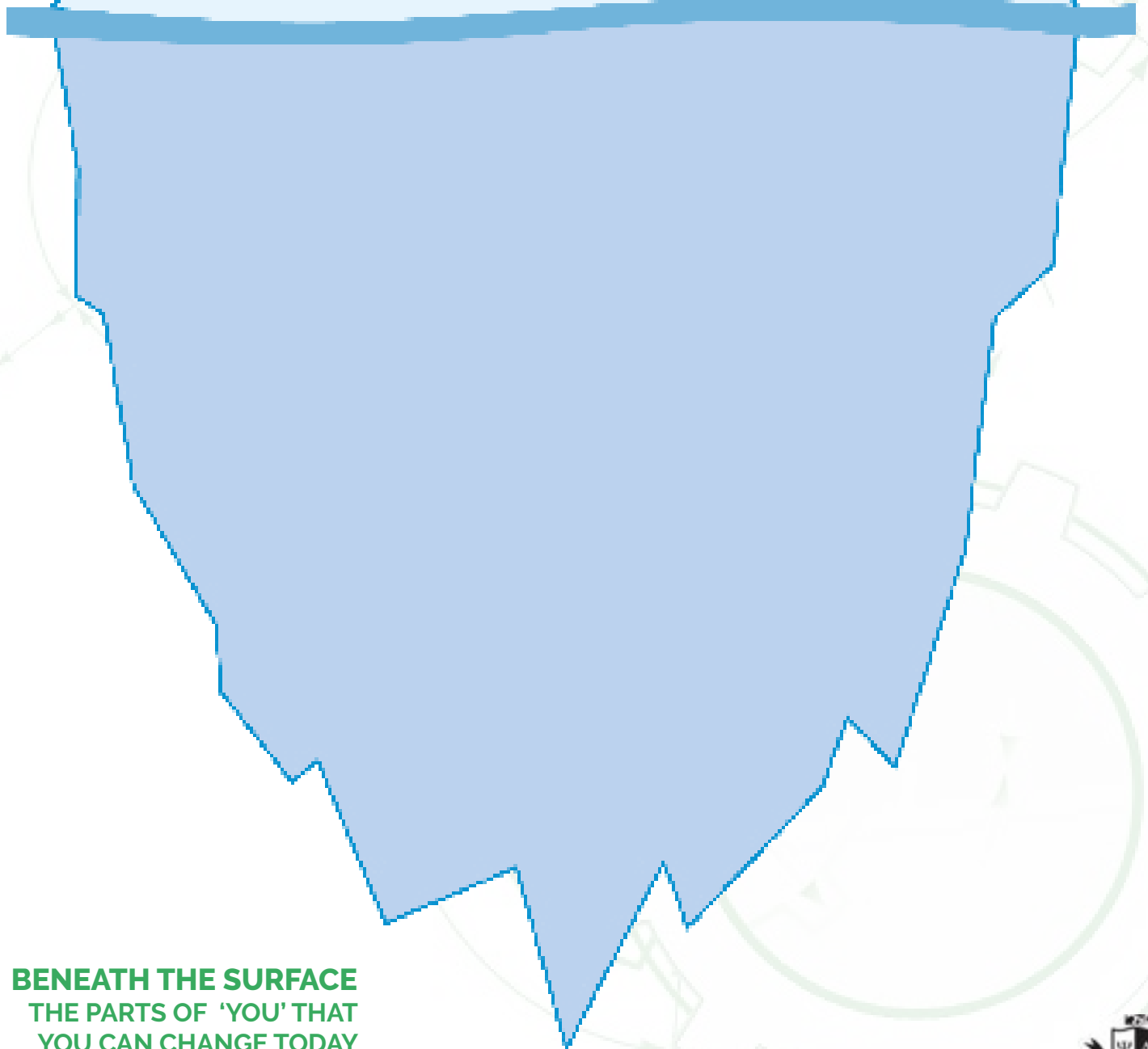


BENEATH THE SURFACE
THE PARTS OF 'YOU'
THAT PEOPLE DON'T SEE



ELIMINATING THE UNCONSCIOUS FACADE

ABOVE THE SURFACE
THE PARTS OF 'YOU' THAT
YOU'D LIKE PEOPLE TO SEE



BENEATH THE SURFACE
THE PARTS OF 'YOU' THAT
YOU CAN CHANGE TODAY

